

Jon Irizar Amuchastegui

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Education

- Copenhagen Business School**, Copenhagen, Denmark *Sept 2023 – Aug 2027*
(expected)
Ph.D. in Financial Economics — primary advisor: Prof. Kasper Meisner Nielsen
- **Thesis:** retail investor behavior and its impact on market efficiency, portfolio composition, and trading.
 - **Methods:** causal inference, panel data econometrics, microeconometrics, and big data.
 - **Datasets:** Danish administrative registries, asset prices, and global M&A transactions.
- University of California, Berkeley, Haas School of Business**, Berkeley, USA *Jan 2026 – Jun 2026*
Visiting Ph.D. student — hosted by Prof. David Sraer
- **Research:** multi-asset behavior and mental accounting.
- Copenhagen Business School**, Copenhagen, Denmark *Sept 2022 – Aug 2025*
M.Sc. in Advanced Economics and Finance
- **GPA:** 11.1/12.0 [Scale from -3 to 12]
 - **Relevant coursework:** Asset Pricing, Econometrics, Derivatives and Behavioral Finance
- Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU)**, Munich, Germany *Oct 2018 – Feb 2022*
B.Sc. in Business Administration
- **GPA:** 1.6/1.0 [Scale from 5.0 to 1.0]
 - Exchange semester at Maastricht University, School of Business and Economics.

Work experience

- Compass Lexecon**, Madrid, Spain *Oct 2025 – Dec 2025*
Research Affiliate — hosted by Dr. Jorge Padilla
- Built difference-in-differences framework analyzing how industry concentration shifts affect retail trading.
 - Linked M&A transactions with Danish trading registries covering 200M+ investor-month observations.
- National Bank of Denmark**, Copenhagen, Denmark *June 2025 – Sep 2025*
Research Intern — hosted by Prof. Steffen Andersen
- Consolidated and cleaned financial datasets to broaden stock & fund coverage.
 - Explored various research topics, incl. interest-rate fluctuations and portfolio rebalancing.
- St. Jørgen Holding ApS**, Copenhagen, Denmark *Feb 2023 – Aug 2023*
Junior Financial Analyst
- Developed DCF and IRR models for solar PV projects to inform divestment strategies.
 - Executed macroeconomic and sensitivity analyses to optimize risk-adjusted returns in renewable investments.
- Deloitte GmbH**, Munich, Germany *Feb 2021 – Aug 2021*
Financial Risk Advisory Intern
- Assessed collateral eligibility for funds with > \$5bn AUM and employed EMIR framework for financial derivatives.
 - Developed and delivered workshops for large transaction banks on emerging risks and risk inventory.

Skills & Languages

- **Programming:** Stata (expert), Python (advanced), R (advanced), L^AT_EX(proficient), SQL (familiar).
- **Modelling & Data Engineering:** factor modelling, parallel computing, large-scale data construction.
- **Data:** Bloomberg, CRSP, Compustat, Refinitiv.
- **Languages:** Spanish (native), Basque (native), English (fluent), German (fluent).

Research

Work in Progress

- **Are Boys Still Boys?** with Steffen Andersen, Kasper Meisner Nielsen, and Abhiroop Mukherjee (Draft available upon request)

We study stock trading among Danish retail investors and find that men trade more than women do, but do not perform significantly worse than women do by doing so, contrary to prior findings.

- **Does market structure matter to retail investors? Evidence from M&A activity** with Jorge Padilla

We examine retail investor behavior conditional on the market structure their stock holdings are in. Employing M&A data, I find that retail investors are more active and are more likely to sell their stock holdings in more concentrated industries.

Grants & Awards

- Distinction for outstanding GPA (June 2018)
- 4+4 PhD grant (Sep 2023)
- Thomas B. Thriges Fond (December 2025)
- Reinholdt W. Jorck og hustrus Fond (December 2025)
- Gudrun og Thomas Nielsen Fonden (December 2025)